

Pre-Flight Privacy Checklist

Engineer

Complete this checklist before every drone flight for structural inspection and engineering survey operations.

Job Details

OPERATOR NAME

DATE OF INSPECTION

ASSET / STRUCTURE NAME

CLIENT / ASSET OWNER

LICENCE / RPA REG NO.

WEATHER CONDITIONS

1 — Consent, Access & Authorisation

- ☐ **Written consent obtained from asset owner / operator**
Engagement letter or access agreement signed authorising drone inspection of the structure.
- ☐ **Third-party property access confirmed**
Any neighbouring land required for take-off, landing or line-of-sight access approved in writing.
- ☐ **Site access permit / induction completed**
Operator holds valid site induction, PPE requirements met, and site supervisor notified.
- ☐ **Sensitive infrastructure classification checked**
Asset assessed for critical infrastructure status (power, water, transport, communications).
- ☐ **Security clearance obtained if required**
Government or defence-related assets: appropriate security clearance confirmed before flight.
- ☐ **Privacy Act obligations explained to client**
Client understands inspection imagery may incidentally capture third-party property or persons.

2 — No-Fly Zones & Airspace

- ☐ **Airspace checked via CASA tool (Airshare / OneSky)**
No restricted, prohibited or controlled airspace within planned flight area.
- ☐ **NOTAM reviewed for inspection date and time**
No active NOTAMs affecting the site.
- ☐ **Proximity to aerodromes confirmed**
5.5 km radius from controlled aerodromes checked; CASA authorisation obtained if required.
- ☐ **Flight within visual line of sight (VLOS) or BVLOS approval held**
VLOS maintained or BVLOS approval from CASA confirmed for long-span structures (bridges, towers).
- ☐ **Operating height at or below 120 m AGL (or approved altitude)**
For tall structures exceeding 120 m, CASA exemption obtained and documented.
- ☐ **Electromagnetic interference (EMI) sources at site assessed**
High-voltage lines, radio towers and industrial equipment identified; compass calibration re-checked.

3 — Privacy Risk Assessment

- ☐ **Adjacent residential or commercial properties identified**
Properties within the inspection flight corridor mapped; owners notified where practicable.
- ☐ **Inspection imagery scope limited to the subject structure**
Camera angle and flight path set to focus on the asset; capture of neighbouring properties minimised.
- ☐ **Workers and site personnel present during inspection briefed**
All persons on site aware of drone operation and approximate flight times.
- ☐ **Public exclusion zone established around the inspection site**
Barriers or spotters in place to prevent unauthorised persons entering the flight zone.
- ☐ **Sensitive data visible on or near the structure assessed**
Security codes, access panels, personal items or private information visible to the camera identified.

4 — Data Collection Limits

- ☐ **Inspection imagery limited to the structural elements specified in the brief**
No speculative capture of areas outside the agreed inspection scope.
- ☐ **Imagery resolution appropriate to inspection purpose**
Resolution set to minimum required for defect detection; unnecessary detail of adjacent private areas avoided.
- ☐ **Personally identifiable information (PII) visible in imagery flagged for redaction**
Faces, vehicle plates, signage or personal data captured incidentally noted for blurring before delivery.
- ☐ **Audio recording disabled**
Onboard microphone off for the duration of the inspection flight.
- ☐ **Thermal or other specialist sensors used only as specified in the brief**
Sensor use documented; data collection limited to agreed inspection deliverables.

5 — Data Handling & Storage

- ☐ **SD card / storage media is blank before the inspection flight**
No residual imagery or data from previous inspections on recording media.
- ☐ **Inspection imagery transferred to encrypted project storage within 24 hours**
AES-256 encrypted drive or approved engineering platform with access controls.
- ☐ **Access to inspection data restricted to authorised project personnel**
Access log maintained; sharing with subconsultants requires written client consent.
- ☐ **Retention period agreed with client; deletion schedule documented**
Raw imagery and reports held per contract obligations; secure deletion on schedule.
- ☐ **Deliverables reviewed for incidental personal data before issue to client**
Inspection reports and imagery checked; PII redacted prior to handover.

6 — Equipment Pre-Flight Check

- ☐ **RPA registration / markings current and visible**
- ☐ **Battery charged at or above 80%; spare batteries checked**
- ☐ **Propellers inspected — no cracks or chips**
- ☐ **Return-to-home altitude set above tallest point of structure plus clearance**
- ☐ **Camera / sensor calibrated; lens clean and appropriate for inspection**
- ☐ **Remote ID broadcasting confirmed (if required)**
- ☐ **Obstacle avoidance sensors tested and active**
- ☐ **Tether system checked if confined-space or indoor inspection planned**

7 — Post-Flight Actions

- ☐ **Inspection imagery reviewed for unintended personal data capture**
Flag imagery of identifiable persons or private property outside inspection scope.
- ☐ **Structural defects or safety hazards identified during flight reported immediately**
Any imminent safety risk observed during inspection escalated to client and site supervisor at once.
- ☐ **Incident log updated if any privacy, safety or airspace issue arose**
Record complaints, near-misses or unplanned captures; notify client if required.
- ☐ **Client provided with copy of this completed checklist**
Signed copy retained by operator for minimum 7 years.

Operator Sign-Off

By signing below I confirm all checklist items have been reviewed and completed to the best of my knowledge.

OPERATOR SIGNATURE

DATE/TIME